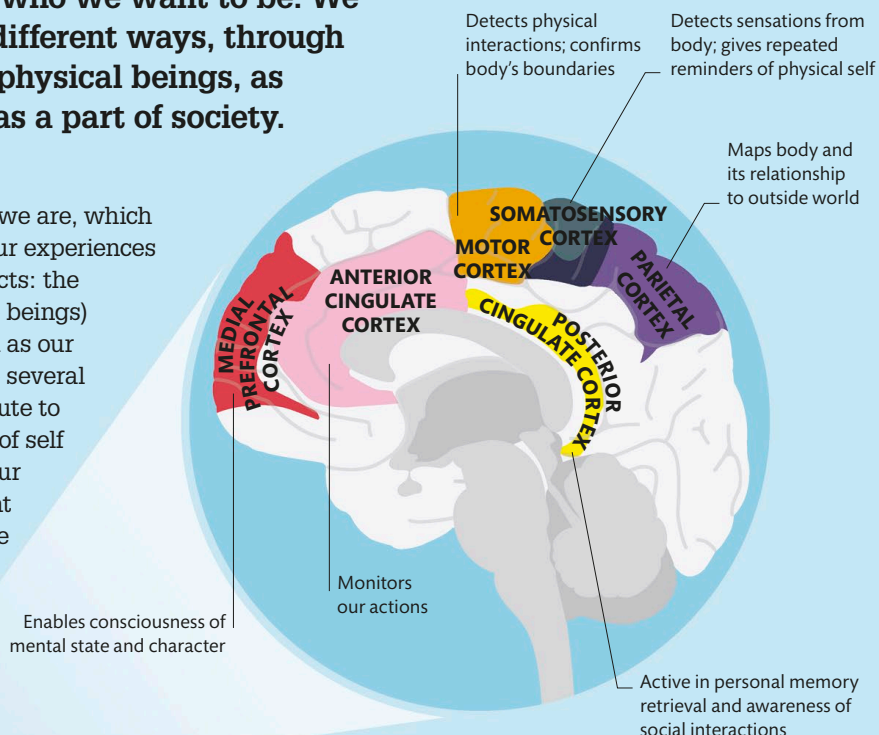


The Self

The self is an accumulation of concepts of who we are, who we were, and who we want to be. We derive our sense of self in different ways, through awareness of ourselves as physical beings, as agents of our actions, and as a part of society.

What is the self?

The self is our internal sense of who we are, which develops through our evaluation of our experiences of the world. It is formed of two aspects: the physical self (who we are as tangible beings) and a mental self (which can be seen as our autobiographical memory). There are several linked areas of the brain that contribute to our sense of self. Our physical sense of self is created by areas that tell us how our body occupies space, while areas that allow us to reflect on our mental state and retrieve memories contribute to our mental self.



The mirror test

To determine whether a human (or animal) has the ability to recognize itself in a mirror, a test called the mirror test is used. A mark is drawn on the face of a subject to see whether they will wipe it off; if they do, it indicates that they have a sense of self. This ability develops at about two years old in humans.

Adult understands reflection is herself so points to her own nose

Baby does not recognize reflection as himself, so points to "other" baby with mark on his nose

